



WAVE PTX™ drives safety and efficiency at Tallinn Zoo

Tallinn Zoo

Established in 1939, Tallinn Zoo is a renowned conservation centre and one of the most popular tourist destinations in Estonia. Its site covers 89 hectares and features two tropical houses and an environmental education centre. The zoo is home to a diverse range of species, including the world's largest collection of mountain goats and sheep, polar bears, elephants and eagles.



Customer

Tallinn Zoo

Partner

DAN Communications

Industry

Tourism

Solutions

A WAVE PTX broadband Push-to-Talk (PTT) Bring Your Own Device (BYOD) service comprising:

- WAVE PTX App
- WAVE PTX Portal



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Challenge

Managing thousands of animals and a large influx of seasonal visitors requires a sophisticated communication strategy that bridges gaps between animal keepers, security teams, and administrative staff. Animal care teams on the ground need to stay in constant, reliable contact with dispatchers and management teams. Indeed, rapid response is critical for animal-related incidents, medical emergencies and general site security.

However, the zoo has a diverse landscape that includes dense forested areas, large enclosures and remote administrative buildings, and the previous analogue radio system could not provide the required coverage across all areas. Moreover, the zoo was keen to introduce new features such as talk groups, GPS tracking and multimedia capabilities.

Solution

Long-term Motorola Solutions partner DAN Communications, therefore, proposed a versatile WAVE PTX broadband PTT service. And, following successful tests across its site, Tallinn Zoo deployed the WAVE PTX mobile app on its existing fleet of smartphones. DAN Communications activated the app, configured the required user settings and talk groups (just two at this stage, one general one and one for vets), and offers ongoing service and support. WAVE PTX leverages both cellular networks and the zoo's private Wi-Fi network without complex infrastructure, ensuring users always have a connection. This enabled a swift, cost-efficient deployment with reliable, seamless coverage across the whole site, and beyond.

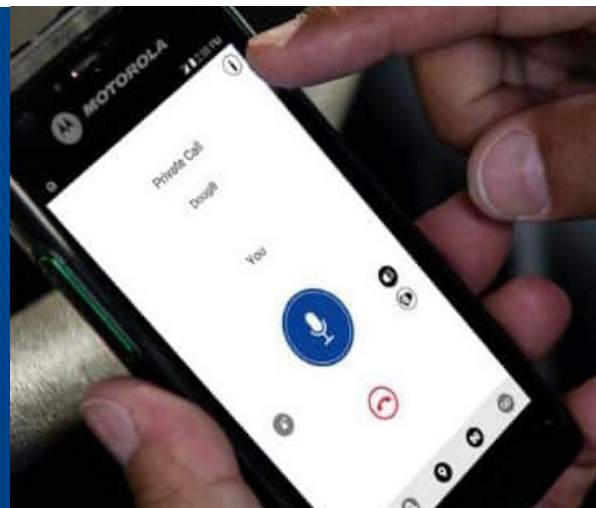
The system is used every day, with subscribers making PTT talk group and individual calls, with the option to initiate emergency calls, share videos and photos, or livestream videos from the app. Controllers, meanwhile, can access the WAVE PTX portal to add and configure users, manage talk groups and programme devices. If needed, users can be located in real time via the GPS tracking feature, and the app has a dedicated emergency button and emergency call priority, so these calls pre-empt any ongoing routine communications. These features help Tallinn Zoo adhere to Occupational Health and Safety rules, which aim to keep teams working in remote enclosures or alone with dangerous animals safe.

The deployment enables Tallinn Zoo to meet various other legislation, regulatory and safety requirements. These include the Estonian Emergency Act, which states that organisations managing public safety risks or vital services must maintain reliable communication channels that can operate even if primary public networks are congested, and the Public Event Safety Standard; as a venue hosting large crowds, the zoo is required to demonstrate a robust incident management plan. WAVE PTX enables clear, logged, and coordinated emergency responses, meeting duty-of-care requirements for public safety.



Working with DAN Communications to implement the Motorola WAVE PTX solution has transformed our site-wide communication, coordination and emergency response capabilities. Their professional support ensured a seamless rollout of WAVE PTX, providing our teams with the reliable, instant connectivity required to keep our visitors and staff safe across the entire zoo.

– Kaido Lasn, Head of Security, Tallinn Zoo



To maintain the standards set by EAZA (European Association of Zoos and Aquaria), Tallinn Zoo conducts safety drills multiple times a year. These exercises simulate scenarios ranging from 'Dangerous animal on the loose', 'Person inside an enclosure', to 'Missing child'. Depending on the complexity of the case, each staff member has a role: managing visitor evacuations, stopping ticket sales, blocking pathways with machinery, and so on. All of this requires seamless communication between different departments, which the WAVE PTX solution provides.

Outcomes

By moving to a broadband-based PTT system, Tallinn Zoo has modernised its operations. Whether a team member is in an enclosure or in the main office, they remain part of a single, secure, reliable network that ensures the safety of the zoo's human and animal residents alike. Indeed, the instant connectivity ensures that critical seconds are saved during animal-related incidents, and the ability to track and check in on users enhances safety.

The BYOD aspect of the solution also brings a range of advantages, such as minimal infrastructure, fast deployment, reduced training, and strong user uptake; workers already know their smartphones. Moreover, staff no longer need to carry, manage, or charge a radio and a smartphone and can access all their communication and workflows on a single device. Moving forward, the zoo may look at further integrating the WAVE PTX system into its existing infrastructure, and maybe implementing a radio gateway between some of its older radios and WAVE PTX so that workers who do not need a smartphone can utilise existing assets throughout their full lifecycle on the WAVE PTX system. The zoo fully appreciates the flexibility and scalability offered by WAVE PTX.



Benefits

- **Instant connectivity:** staff communicate instantly at the push of a button, ensuring that critical seconds are saved during animal-related incidents
- **Multimedia capabilities:** keepers can send photos and videos of animal health concerns or habitat damage directly to specialists for immediate review
- **Real-time location tracking:** supervisors can see the real-time location of all app users for faster incident response and increased safety
- **"Out of the box" simplicity:** the system was preconfigured to the zoo's specific requirements, meaning it was operational upon deployment
- **BYOD efficiency:** utilising the app on staff's existing smartphones saves costs and ensures fast user uptake
- **Remote management and support:** via the WAVE PTX portal





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